

Ugur Mert Yasar

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Education

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business, IL

Expected June 2027

PhD, Behavioral Science

MBA

Harvard University, MA

July 2026 – June 2027

Visiting PhD Student, Department of Psychology

University of British Columbia, BC

June 2020

Bachelor of International Economics, Vancouver School of Economics

Thesis: Islamic Rule's Effects on Women's Labor Force Participation: Evidence from Turkey

Doctoral Dissertation

Title: The Institutional Architecture of Norms and Enforcement

Committee: Joshua Conrad Jackson (Chair), James A. Robinson, Devin Pope, Joshua T. Dean, Thomas Talhelm

Research Interests

Rules, norms, cultural tightness, institutional economics, social learning, argumentativeness

Working Papers

1. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement." [*Job Market Paper; data analysis in progress*]
2. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Sahakari, S., & Götz, F. "Rulebooks and Relationships: An Institutional Model of Cultural Tightness." [*Invited proposal, Perspectives on Psychological Science*]
3. **Yasar, U. M.**, & Jackson, J. C. "Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures." [*Complete manuscript available on request*]
4. Jackson, J. C., **Yasar, U. M.**, Liu, Y., & Dorison, C. "Social Learning Can Produce Costly Status Quo Preferences Without a Status Quo Bias." [*Complete manuscript available on request*]

Work in Progress

5. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Deconstructing Cultural Tightness: Formal and Informal Dimensions of Norm Enforcement Across 92 Cultures." [*Data analysis in progress*]
6. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Cultural Tightness-Looseness Revisited After 15 Years: Updated Scores and Correlates Across 92 Cultures." [*Data analysis in progress*]
7. **Yasar, U. M.**, Talhelm, T., Wei, L., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries." [*Data analysis in progress*]
8. **Yasar, U. M.**, Zhang, S., & Jackson, J. C. "Substitutes or Complements? Formal and Informal Enforcement in a Public Goods Game." [*Pilot data analysis*]
9. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., & Pope, D. "Enemy at the Board: How Political Tension Predicts Unsportsmanlike Behavior in International Chess." [*Data analysis in progress*]

Awards and Honors

Global Health Summer Fellowship , Center for Global Health, The University of Chicago — \$7,500	2023
Development Economics Research Fund , Becker Friedman Institute, The University of Chicago — \$4,578 (<i>Declined</i>)	2022
Work-Learn International Undergraduate Research Award , University of British Columbia — CAD \$7,000	2018
Outstanding Practicum Award , University of British Columbia — CAD \$8,000	2015

Presentations

- “The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement”** Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.
- *Organized Symposium* (Co-Chair): “The Lifecycle of Norms: Novel Insights from Around the World,” Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Chicago (February 2026)
 - *Talk*: International Association for Conflict Management, Burlington (July 2025)
- “Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures”** Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.
- *Talk*: Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Denver (February 2025)
 - *Invited Talk*: Behavioral Brownbag, Booth School of Business, The University of Chicago (May 2024)
- “Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries”** Yasar, U. M., Talhelm, T., & Wei, L.
- *Poster*: Global Health Research Symposium, Biological Sciences Division, The University of Chicago (October 2023)

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, The University of Chicago

The Study of Behavioral Economics MBA, Chicago · <i>Professor Devin Pope</i>	Winter 2024, 2025, 2026
Statistics Executive MBA, Hong Kong and London · <i>Professor Chris Hansen</i>	Autumn 2024 – Winter 2025
Behavioral Economics: Development and Observational Data PhD, Chicago · <i>Professors Devin Pope and Joshua T. Dean</i>	Autumn 2023
Managerial Decision Making Executive MBA, Hong Kong · <i>Professor Chris Hsee</i>	Autumn 2023
Behavioral Economics: Theory and the Lab PhD, Chicago · <i>Professor Alex Imas</i>	Spring 2023
Behavioral Economics Undergraduate, Chicago · <i>Professor Alex Imas</i>	Spring 2023

Research Experience

Research Assistant Vancouver School of Economics, University of British Columbia · <i>Professor Matt Lowe</i>	2020 – 2021
Research Assistant , Culture and Self Lab University of British Columbia · <i>Professor Steven J. Heine</i>	2019 – 2021
Research Assistant , Motivation and Goals in Contexts (MAGIC) Lab University of British Columbia · <i>Professor Kristin Laurin</i>	2018 – 2021
Research Assistant Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia · <i>Professor Álvaro Parra</i>	2018

Skills

Software R, Stata, Python, SPSS, Qualtrics

Languages Turkish (native), English (fluent), Spanish (beginner)